



Alexandria National University

Faculty of Computer and Data Science

Project Tittle: Game Theory_(01416N)

Project Title: Strategic Competition Simulation

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Strategic Competition Simulation Using Game Theory

Cournot Competition Between Two Firms

1. Problem Description

This project studies strategic interaction between two firms competing in a market using Game Theory concepts.

The model is based on **Cournot Competition**, where each firm decides its production quantity independently while considering the competitor's decision.

The project aims to analyze:

- Strategic behavior of firms
- Nash Equilibrium
- Best response dynamics
- Market efficiency
- Impact of cost and demand changes
- Leader-Follower (Stackelberg) competition

The system is fully implemented using Python and includes simulation, visualization, and analytical solutions.

2. Game Modeling

Players

- Firm A
- Firm B

Strategy Space

The model uses:

Quantity Competition (Cournot Model)

Each firm chooses:

for Firm A q_1

for Firm B q_2

Market Price Function

$$P = a - b(q_1 + q_2)$$

Profit Functions

Firm A Profit

$$\pi_1 = (P - c_1)q_1$$

Firm B Profit

$$\pi_2 = (P - c_2)q_2$$

3. Theoretical Analysis

Best Response Functions

Firm A

$$BR_1(q_2) = \frac{a - c_1 - bq_2}{2b}$$

Firm B

$$BR_2(q_1) = \frac{a - c_2 - bq_1}{2b}$$

Nash Equilibrium

Equilibrium Quantities

$$q_1^* = \frac{a - 2c_1 + c_2}{3b}$$

$$q_2^* = \frac{a - 2c_2 + c_1}{3b}$$

At equilibrium:

- Each firm is playing its best response
- No firm can improve profit unilaterally

4. Game Representation

Normal Form Representation

The payoff matrix is implemented using Python dictionaries / arrays.

===== NORMAL FORM PAYOFF MATRIX =====

```
Firm A Quantity = 10
Firm B Quantity = 10 --> Payoffs (600, 600)
Firm B Quantity = 20 --> Payoffs (500, 1000)
Firm B Quantity = 30 --> Payoffs (400, 1200)
Firm B Quantity = 40 --> Payoffs (300, 1200)
```

```
Firm A Quantity = 20
Firm B Quantity = 10 --> Payoffs (1000, 500)
Firm B Quantity = 20 --> Payoffs (800, 800)
Firm B Quantity = 30 --> Payoffs (600, 900)
Firm B Quantity = 40 --> Payoffs (400, 800)
```

```
Firm A Quantity = 30
Firm B Quantity = 10 --> Payoffs (1200, 400)
Firm B Quantity = 20 --> Payoffs (900, 600)
Firm B Quantity = 30 --> Payoffs (600, 600)
Firm B Quantity = 40 --> Payoffs (300, 400)
```

```
Firm A Quantity = 40
Firm B Quantity = 10 --> Payoffs (1200, 300)
Firm B Quantity = 20 --> Payoffs (800, 400)
Firm B Quantity = 30 --> Payoffs (400, 300)
Firm B Quantity = 40 --> Payoffs (0, 0)
```

Extensive Form Representation

The game is represented as a decision tree:

===== EXTENSIVE FORM TREE =====

Firm A chooses: Low Quantity

- > Firm B responds: Low
- > Firm B responds: Medium
- > Firm B responds: High

Firm A chooses: Medium Quantity

- > Firm B responds: Low
- > Firm B responds: Medium
- > Firm B responds: High

Firm A chooses: High Quantity

- > Firm B responds: Low
- > Firm B responds: Medium
- > Firm B responds: High

This represents:

- Firm A moves first
- Firm B responds after observing A's decision

5. Python Implementation

The project is implemented using:

- Object-Oriented Programming (OOP)
- NumPy for computations
- Matplotlib for visualization

Main Classes:

- CournotCompetition
- ExtensiveFormGame
- SimulationManager

The system supports:

- Parameter changes (cost, demand, sensitivity)
- Multiple simulations
- Scenario comparison

6. Simulation Scenarios

The model is tested under different market conditions:

Scenario 1: Base Case

Standard market conditions.

Base Nash Equilibrium Output

```
===== NASH EQUILIBRIUM =====  
Firm A Quantity : 26.67  
Firm B Quantity : 26.67  
Market Price : 46.67  
Firm A Profit : 711.11  
Firm B Profit : 711.11
```

Scenario 2: High Cost (Firm A)

Firm A has higher production cost.

Cost Impact

```
Scenario: High Cost for Firm A  
=====  
Firm A Quantity : 16.67  
Firm B Quantity : 31.67  
Market Price : 51.67  
Firm A Profit : 277.78  
Firm B Profit : 1002.78
```

Scenario 3: Demand Increase

Market demand increases.

```
Scenario: Demand Increase  
=====  
Firm A Quantity : 40.00  
Firm B Quantity : 40.00  
Market Price : 60.00  
Firm A Profit : 1600.00  
Firm B Profit : 1600.00
```

Scenario 4: Demand Decrease

Market demand decreases.

```
Scenario: Demand Decrease
=====
Firm A Quantity : 16.67
Firm B Quantity : 16.67
Market Price : 36.67
Firm A Profit : 277.78
Firm B Profit : 277.78
```

Scenario 5: High Market Price Sensitivity

Price becomes more sensitive to quantity changes.

```
Scenario: High Market Price Sensitivity
=====
Firm A Quantity : 66.67
Firm B Quantity : 66.67
Market Price : 53.33
Firm A Profit : 2222.22
Firm B Profit : 2222.22
```

Stackelberg Competition (Leader–Follower)

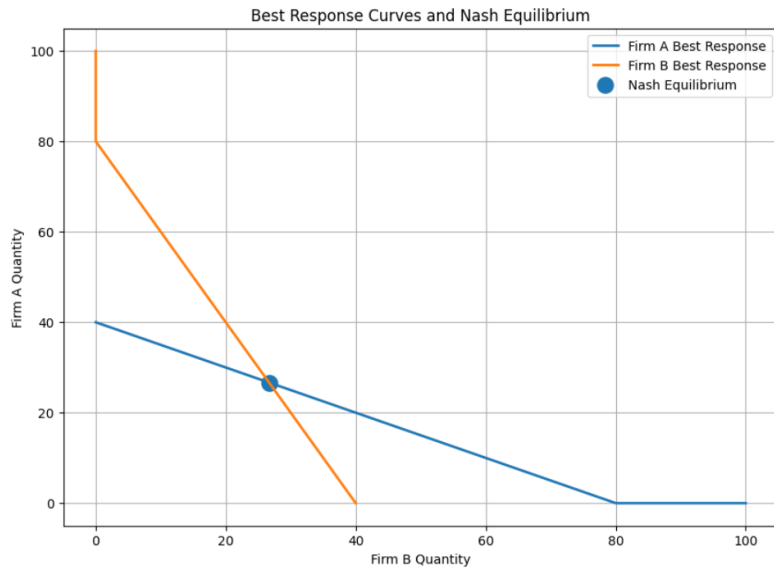
Firm A acts as leader, Firm B follows.

```
===== STACKELBERG EQUILIBRIUM =====
Leader Quantity : 40.00
Follower Quantity : 20.00
Market Price : 40.00
Leader Profit : 800.00
Follower Profit : 400.00
```

7. Visualization Results

The project generates multiple visual outputs:

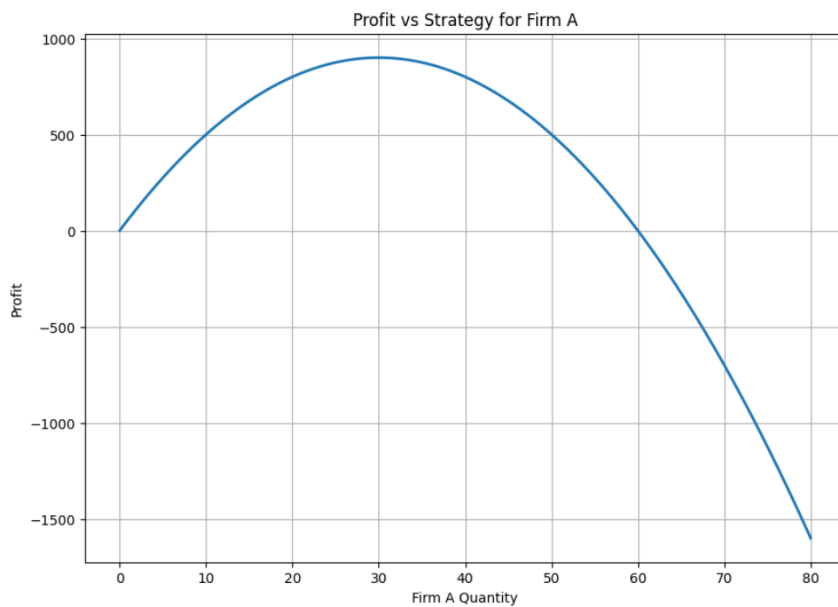
Best Response Curves



Shows:

- Intersection point = Nash Equilibrium

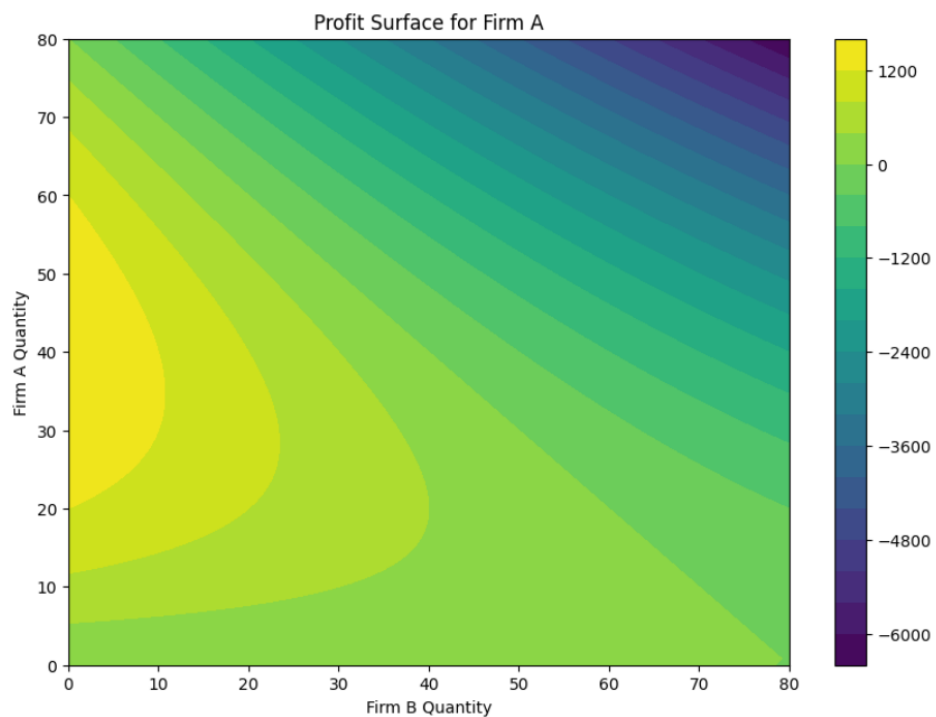
Profit vs Strategy



Shows how profit changes with quantity.

Profit Surface

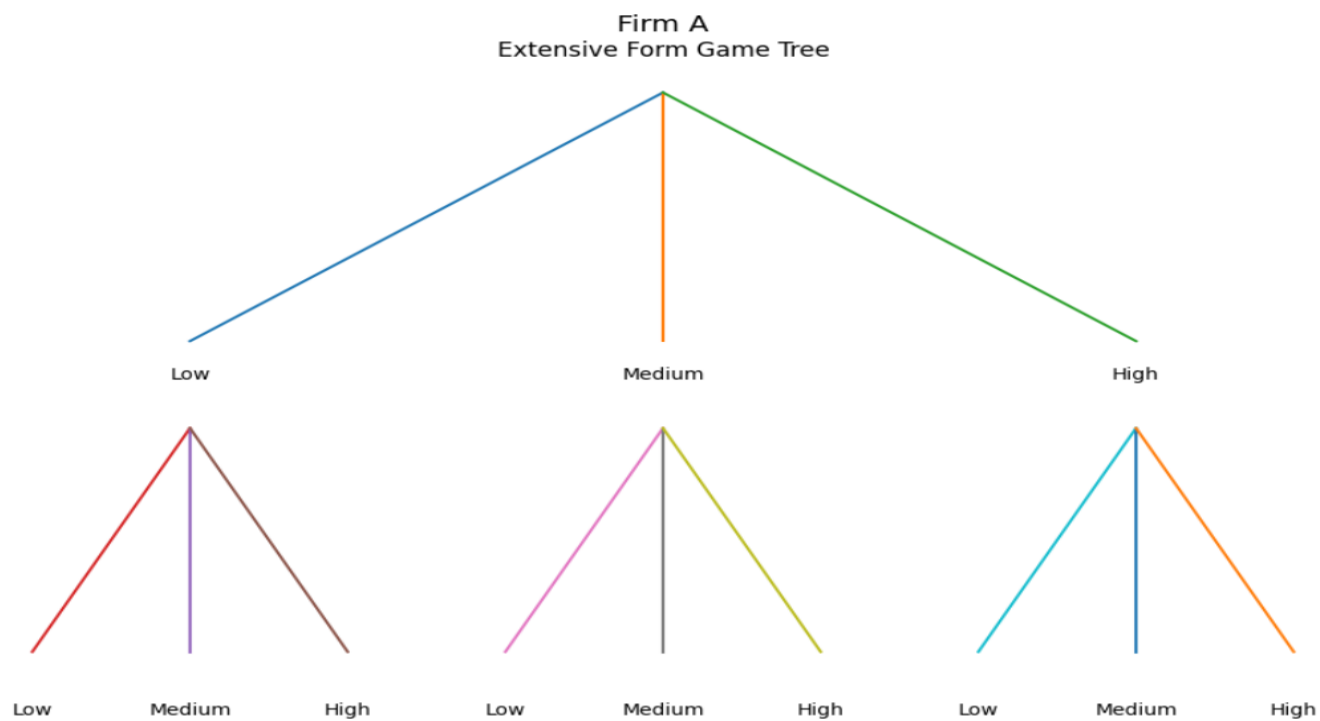
3D/Contour Profit Surface



Shows profit distribution across strategies.

Extensive Form Tree

Game Tree Visualization



8. Results

The simulation shows:

- Firms always adjust strategies based on competitors
- Nash equilibrium is stable across scenarios
- Market demand strongly affects output and profit
- Higher costs reduce competitiveness
- Strategic interdependence is clearly visible

9. Insights

Why Equilibrium Occurs

Equilibrium occurs because:

- Each firm selects its best response
- No unilateral deviation improves payoff

Efficiency

Cournot equilibrium is:

- Stable
- But not socially optimal

Because:

- Firms restrict output
- Prices remain above marginal cost

Real-World Applications

This model applies to:

- Airlines
- Oil industry
- Telecom markets
- Tech competition (Intel vs AMD, Boeing vs Airbus)

10. Conclusion

This project successfully models strategic market competition using Game Theory.

It includes:

- Mathematical modeling
- Nash equilibrium analysis
- Simulation under multiple scenarios
- Visualization of strategic behavior
- Extensive and normal form games
- Stackelberg competition

The results demonstrate how firms behave strategically in real-world competitive markets.

Scan Qr_Code To get Source Code :

